

OUR CALL

ATL WIN PROB

ATL by 11.2

68%



CHI win 32% · pick'em (0) · ATL win 68%

Shaded area each side of pick'em = each team's win chance; dark tick = our call.

Projected score ATL 86 — CHI 79 · Total 172

Some inputs served from the most-recent available build (winprob) — see companion file for detail.

Read

ATL is a clear favorite (68% to win). The catch: CHI is down a rotation piece — S. Diggins (impact +0.9) is OUT and already removed from the projection below.

- ATL is a clear favorite here (68% to win); we project ATL 86, CHI 79.
- The model's on-court player ratings tilt to ATL — its top three rate +6.5 combined vs +3.5 on the other side (impact = points added vs an average player; see the box).
- Availability: ATL without T. Paopao (1 OUT); CHI without R. Jackson, D. Carrington, S. Diggins (3 OUT) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the ATL margin lands between -10 and +26 (+ = ATL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so ATL loses outright about 32% of the time; a big projected margin like this is the hardest kind to hit exactly.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

TEAM	PLAYER	STATUS / CAUSE	GAMES MISSED	EXP. RETURN
CHI	Ricke Jackson	Torn ACL — out for season	21	Out for season
CHI	DiJonai Carrington	Foot	—	Jul 22
CHI	Skylar Diggins	Knee	5	Jul 22
ATL	Te-Hina Paopao	Leg	1	Jul 29

Cause read from the injury feed's report; games missed = the team's games played since the player last appeared; expected return as reported ('TBD' = no date given).

Players to watch

Each side's top two projected scorers — biggest game-changer first (impact = points added vs an average player); the % is the team's scoring each carries.

CHI S. Taylor 12 pts (15% of CHI's scoring) / 2 reb / 2 ast in 24 min · +1.2 impact · K. Cardoso 13 pts (16% of CHI's scoring) / 9 reb / 2 ast in 26 min · +0.3 impact

ATL A. Gray 16 pts (18% of ATL's scoring) / 2 reb / 2 ast in 30 min · +1.3 impact · A. Reese 15 pts (17% of ATL's scoring) / 10 reb / 2 ast in 29 min · -0.2 impact

Projected box

Big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters (top-5 minutes) · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated).

Source: per-slate minutes + player-rate projections, availability-adjusted (minutes → 200, points scaled to the simulation score).

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
30	A. Stevens	-0.9	26.7	10.9	6.7	2.8	1.3
10	K. Cardoso	+0.3	25.9	12.8	8.6	2.3	0.1
9	N. Cloud	+0.4	25.7	8.1	2.6	4.4	1.2
12	S. Taylor	+1.2	23.6	11.9	2.1	1.8	2.0
11	G. Jaquez	+0.1	18.3	6.9	3.0	1.2	0.7
22	C. Vandersloot	+1.9	17.2	7.0	2.0	3.6	0.7
0	J. Sheldon	+0.3	14.8	5.0	1.0	1.3	0.7
35	A. Coulibaly	+0.3	12.2	4.8	2.9	0.7	0.4
1	E. Williams	-0.5	11.9	4.0	2.8	1.2	0.1
24	R. Banham	-1.0	10.5	3.4	1.1	1.0	0.7
21	M. Westbeld	-0.4	8.6	2.5	1.6	0.6	0.4
	F · 6'3" · thin sample						
—	S. Poffenbarger	-0.3	4.6	1.3	0.9	0.4	0.2
	thin sample						
	Team		200.0	78.6			

ATL

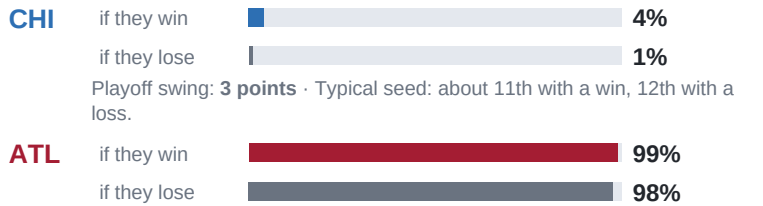
#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
10	R. Howard	-0.5	31.8	14.1	3.7	2.8	2.7
3	J. Canada	+3.4	31.2	11.5	3.4	7.4	1.0
15	A. Gray	+1.3	30.2	15.7	2.5	2.4	1.5
5	A. Reese	-0.2	29.0	14.7	9.9	1.8	0.3
00	N. Hillmon	+1.8	26.3	7.8	4.2	1.3	1.0
42	B. Jones	—	13.8	5.3	3.7	1.7	0.3
	F · 6'3" · thin sample						
20	I. Borlase	-0.1	13.5	4.9	1.4	1.1	0.7
11	M. Okot	-1.4	11.0	6.4	3.4	0.4	0.2
23	S. Kone	+1.2	7.1	2.8	1.3	0.4	0.4
21	I. Nivar	+0.7	1.9	0.7	0.3	0.2	0.1
	G · 5'10" · thin sample						
33	S. Walker-Kimbrough	+1.0	1.8	0.7	0.2	0.2	0.1
	G · 5'9" · thin sample						
32	A. Nye	-0.1	1.5	0.6	0.1	0.2	0.1
	G · 6'0" · thin sample						
—	A. Okonkwo	-0.4	0.9	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.0
	thin sample						
	Team		200.0	85.6			

A deeper look

What tonight means

A win tonight puts **CHI**'s playoff chances at **4%** — a loss drops them to **1%**.

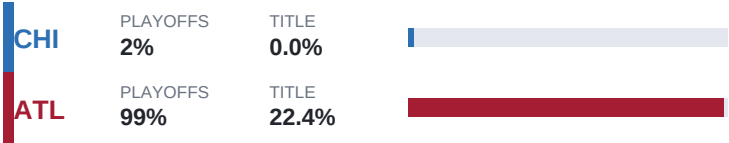
Across both teams that makes this the **3rd-biggest playoff-swing game** of this week's 6 remaining games.



Playoff swing: **1 points** · Typical seed: about 5th either way.

Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

Season odds — playoffs & title



Source: live 1M-run season simulation (the board's odds core).

Starting-five skill profiles

30 A. Stevens



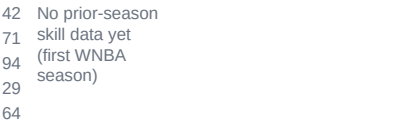
10 K. Cardoso



9 N. Cloud



12 S. Taylor



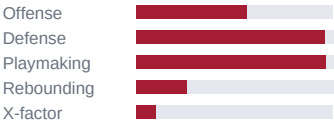
11 G. Jaquez

No prior-season skill data yet (first WNBA season)

10 R. Howard



3 J. Canada



15 A. Gray



5 A. Reese



00 N. Hillmon



Source: league-percentile bars from each player's most recent full-season profile (the 2025 season); first-year players have none yet. Estimated from public play-by-play.

Appendix — how the numbers are made

- Scores, totals & the margin distribution = a 1M-run Monte-Carlo simulation; spread = regression + home recalibration; the margin curve & ranges are calibrated intervals (~89% observed coverage at the 90% target); playoff leverage = the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result.
- Player values = per-minute rates (last-10-games form → season → positional average) × projected minutes, team points scaled to the simulation total. Minutes = per-slate projection + injury redistribution under per-player caps — OUT players removed and their minutes reallocated (box sums to 200; a “provisional” team has rotation players missing from tonight’s model, so its box shows only the modeled minutes and is not inflated).
- Some player-level estimates lean on the limited public play-by-play for this league; richer tracking data would sharpen them.

THE SEASON SO FAR (through 998 games): Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.8 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 68% of the time · player minutes within +/-6.0, points within +/-3.9 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)
Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better): May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.
all-games: spread +/-10.8 · minutes +/-6.0 · points +/-3.8

Generated 2026-07-19T04:00:13Z · report of record. Built by The Hardwood from existing production models — no new models and no hand-entered numbers. Full methodology and sources are in this game's companion notes.